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Senator Joseph E. East
House of Representatives
Washington 25, D. C.

Dear Mr. East:

In response to your 30 June inquiry concerning statements made by Leon Davidson in his 26 June letter to you, please be advised that Mr. Davidson has been involved in rather extensive correspondence with this Agency and with the Air Force since early 1958 on the matter of UFO's.

Mr. Davidson believes that the Central Intelligence Agency is withholding information from him which would prove that this Agency is, to quote his letter to you "... solely responsible for creating the Flying Saucer fiasco. . . ." He believes further that this information is contained in the Scientific Advisory Panel Report on UFO's, dated 17 January 1953, (Secret). Mr. Davidson was supplied with the declassified and "official" version of this report, but this apparently has only served to convince that what is being withheld is information which would prove his claim. This is in spite of the fact that he was informed as long ago as 27 May 1958 that "The complete formal report of the panel has not been fully declassified for security reasons. The Formal Report is not available to the general public for distribution or reproduction," and "For your information, the classified portion of the Formal Report and the unofficial supplement did not deal specifically with UFO's but on other matters of intelligence significance which affect the national security." In addition, Major Tacker went to great lengths, in this four page letter, outlining to Mr. Davidson all of the information currently available on the subject of UFO's interpreting the Formal Report of the Scientific Advisory Panel, commenting on erroneous or

Letter from Major Lawrence J. Tacker, U.S. Air Force Executive
Officer, Public Information Division, Office of Information
Services

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misleading statements on this report in Captain Russell's book, "The Report of Unidentified Flying Objects", and explaining why a portion of the report was classified. A copy of this letter is appended for your information.

In summary, Mr. Davidson's belief that this Agency is involved in the "Flying Saucer rumors" and is using this as a tool in psychological warfare is entirely unfounded. His indication that CIA is misleading persons in leading them to believe in Flying Saucers is also entirely unfounded. This Agency in conjunction with the Air Force investigated, in 1958, the threat to national security of the then prevalent Flying Saucer rumors. Since that time, CIA has not participated in any Flying Saucer activities and has referred all correspondence to the U. S. Air Force.

Very truly yours,

Lawrence R. Houston
General Counsel

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Enclosures:

1. Letter, 26 June 1961,
from L. Davidson
2. Letter, 20 May 1958,
from Major Tucker

Distribution:

- Orig. & 1 - Fwd
- 2 - General Counsel
- 1 - Inspector General
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OSI/ASD [Redacted] (8791) [15/2]

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<u>DATE OF LETTER</u>	<u>FROM</u>	<u>TO</u>	<u>SUBSTANCE</u>
11 March 1958	Davidson	DCI	Request for the Secret Panel Report.
14 April 1958	Exec/CIA	Davidson	Davidson's letter referred to Air Force.
27 April 1958	Davidson	DCI	Desires Secret report for public dissemination. (Air Force has action.)
15 May 1958	Davidson	Exec/CIA	Letter forwarded by Chapin to Air Force for reply with acknowledgment letter from Chapin to Davidson.
20 May 1958	Department of Air Force	Davidson	Answer to Davidson's letters of 27 April to Air Force and CIA. Attempts to clarify the purpose of withholding certain information for security reasons.
3 July 1958	Davidson	DCI	Inquires whether CIA is carrying out Sociological Warfare in creating UFO stories.
26 June 1961	Davidson	Congressman Karth	Accuses CIA of creating UFO furor and misleading persons such as Major Keyhue.

NOTE: In addition, we have on file letters from Mr. Davidson to Members of the 1953 Panel requesting in essence their supporting him in obtaining information which would implicate CIA or the OCB in a "1984 type of thought control developing in America."